manner. Concluding Migration and Mobility Partnership Agreements (MMPAs) with countries ranging from Australia to Germany are the policy reflections of this concern.

DELIVERING ON PARTNERSHIPS

The progress report of the last decade is an encouraging one. Stronger expressions of diplomatic energies and activities have clearly raised India's profile in global councils. Prime Minister Modi, in particular, is perceived as a global figure who, while advancing his national interest, has a broader vision and a commitment to collective good. When it comes to the complex challenges that inevitably arise in world affairs, India is no longer seen as ducking the tough decisions.

The regional perception in the Subcontinent started to change from 2014. Understandably, this has not been a linear path, but overall, there is appreciation for the enormous strides that connectivity, cooperation and contacts have made. The extended neighbourhood also appreciates India's stronger sense of purpose as well as high-level visits happening after such long gaps. Where the major powers are concerned, they, too, have seen India prepared to engage more confidently and independently, perhaps in its engagement with multiple partners on defence, technology and energy or, indeed, standing its ground firmly when it comes to protecting its national interests from external pressures.

There is a global dimension to India's progress, which is no less important. In myriad ways, we have been active on a range of international issues that actually shape our contemporary era. Whether it is debt relief, global minimum tax or fairer market access, India has been a powerful voice in global conversations. When it comes to terrorism, India's own counter-actions and collaboration in restricting terror financing and listing of sanctioned terrorists have contributed to greater international awareness. We not only took the debate on maritime security to the UNSC but are participating in concrete initiatives across the Indo-Pacific, including hosting a key fusion centre.

One subject on which India made a decisive difference was connectivity. By taking a comprehensive and clear-cut view of the principles underpinning it, its policymakers were able to shape the debate in favour of greater transparency and better viability. But what has affected